Role

You are an experienced MBA case writer from BCG/Bain/IIM Ahmedabad. Create a comprehensive business case for an MBA CaseQuest competition (4-hour case solving + 10-minute presentation).

Objective

Develop a realistic, data-driven, contemporary case on:

"Should a Quick Commerce company (Zepto/Blinkit-like) enter and scale in Tier-2 and Tier-3 India while achieving sustainable profitability?"

The case should be based on current Indian market realities (2025-2026), industry trends, and realistic assumptions.

Case Context

A fictional company, **SwiftKart**, is India's third-largest quick commerce player and has achieved strong penetration in metro cities. Growth in metros is slowing, customer acquisition costs are rising, and investors are demanding profitability.

SwiftKart's leadership is considering expansion into a Tier-2 city, **City X**.

The company has approved an investment budget of **₹50 crore for a 3-year horizon**.

The CEO has asked the City Expansion Team to determine whether expansion is viable and, if yes, design an end-to-end strategy.

Deliverable Structure

SECTION 1: Executive Summary

- One-page case overview
- Key dilemma
- Strategic importance
- Objectives and constraints

SECTION 2: Industry Overview (India Quick Commerce Market)

Include:

- Current market size
- Growth rates
- Major players
- Revenue models
- Unit economics
- Consumer trends
- Market saturation in metros
- Expansion trends into Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities
- Industry profitability challenges

Include realistic numbers and assumptions.

SECTION 3: Competitive Landscape

Conduct competitor analysis of:

1. Blinkit
2. Zepto
3. Instamart
4. BigBasket Now
5. Local Kirana ecosystem

For each competitor, include:

- Business model
- Strengths
- Weaknesses
- Geographic presence
- Pricing strategy
- Delivery promise
- Key differentiators

Provide:

- Porter Five Forces Analysis
- Strategic Group Map

- Competitor Positioning Matrix

SECTION 4: City X Background

Create a realistic Tier-2 Indian city profile containing:

- Population
- Income distribution
- Digital penetration
- Internet usage
- Smartphone penetration
- Working professionals
- Students
- Residential clusters
- Commercial areas
- Traffic conditions
- Existing retail ecosystem
- Kirana density
- Food delivery penetration
- Consumer buying behavior
- Average household spending on groceries
- Consumer preferences
- Price sensitivity
- Convenience sensitivity

Include maps/tables wherever possible.

SECTION 5: Problem Statement

The management committee wants answers to the following:

1. Should SwiftKart enter City X?
2. Can quick commerce be profitable in this market?
3. Which customer segments should be targeted?
4. How many dark stores should be opened?
5. Where should they be located?
6. What categories should be prioritized?
7. What should be the pricing and delivery strategy?
8. How should the ₹50 crore investment be allocated?
9. How can the company compete with trusted local kiranas?

10. What KPIs should be tracked?

SECTION 6: Internal Challenges

Develop realistic challenges around:

Operations

- Dark store economics
- Inventory planning
- Demand forecasting
- Last-mile delivery costs
- Delivery fleet management

Marketing

- Customer acquisition cost
- Low awareness
- Customer retention
- Building trust

Finance

- Negative contribution margins
- Investor pressure
- Payback period

Technology

- Demand prediction
- Routing optimization
- App adoption

Human Resources

- Delivery partner availability
- Attrition
- Store staffing

SECTION 7: External Challenges

Create realistic challenges involving:

Customers

- Low urgency for 10-minute delivery
- Price sensitivity
- Preference for local stores

Competition

- Kirana stores
- Regional grocery chains
- National players

Regulatory

- Labor regulations
- Gig worker issues
- Municipal permissions

Economic

- Inflation
- Fuel price volatility

Social

- Trust deficit
- Habit inertia
- Low digital adoption among older consumers

Environmental

- Packaging waste
- Sustainability expectations

Use **PESTLE Analysis**.

SECTION 8: Exhibits

Create **15–20 professional exhibits** similar to consulting cases.

Examples:

- Exhibit 1: Indian Quick Commerce Market Size (2022–2030)
- Exhibit 2: Competitor Market Shares
- Exhibit 3: City X Demographic Profile
- Exhibit 4: Consumer Survey Results
- Exhibit 5: Household Income Segments
- Exhibit 6: Order Frequency by Income Group
- Exhibit 7: Average Order Value Estimates
- Exhibit 8: Dark Store Cost Structure
- Exhibit 9: Delivery Cost Breakdown
- Exhibit 10: Customer Acquisition Cost Benchmarks
- Exhibit 11: Potential Dark Store Locations
- Exhibit 12: Heat Map of Demand Clusters
- Exhibit 13: Projected P&L
- Exhibit 14: Three-Year Financial Forecast
- Exhibit 15: Unit Economics per Order
- Exhibit 16: Kirana vs Quick Commerce Comparison
- Exhibit 17: Scenario Analysis
- Exhibit 18: Sensitivity Analysis
- Exhibit 19: Customer Personas
- Exhibit 20: Investor Expectations Dashboard

Each exhibit should contain realistic data tables and charts.

SECTION 9: Facilitator Guide (For Judges Only)

Prepare:

- Key evaluation criteria
- Strong solution approaches
- Weak solution approaches
- Common mistakes
- Scoring rubric (100 marks)

Evaluation dimensions:

- Strategic thinking
- Analytical rigor
- Financial reasoning
- Operational feasibility

- Innovation
- Presentation quality

Output Requirements

The case should resemble an IIM/ISB/BCG consulting competition case packet.

Requirements:

- Professional and realistic.
- Multi-functional (strategy, operations, marketing, finance, analytics).
- No single correct answer.
- Data should allow multiple solution pathways.
- Include sufficient information for a 4-hour MBA case competition and a 5-6 slide final presentation.
- Use tables, exhibits, assumptions, and numbers that are internally consistent.
- Clearly indicate which data is provided to participants and which information is only for organizers/judges.